

Block 5 Bonus — A Research Cockpit: NotebookLM

Goal

Meet a different kind of AI surface. Antigravity (Block 5) was an agent that *acts* on files. NotebookLM is the opposite: a free, Gemini-powered tool that *reads your documents* and answers from them — with citations — and can turn them into a study guide or a podcast. You will feed it this workshop’s own handouts and watch it become an instant study buddy. No API key, no payment — just a Google account.

Type this

You will not type code here — this is a web tool. Follow the clicks.

1. Open notebooklm.google.com and sign in with the **same Google account** you used for Antigravity (free, no payment).
2. Click **Create** (or **New notebook**).
3. **Add sources**: click **Add** and upload the workshop handout PDFs your facilitator shared (the pdf/ folder — e.g. b2-loop-and-goal.pdf, b3-efforts-and-tokens.pdf, b4-mcp-and-github.pdf, and README.pdf). You can also paste a link or text as a source.
4. Wait a few seconds for NotebookLM to read the sources, then ask a grounded question in the chat box: What is the Read-Plan-Edit-Verify loop, and why does it matter?
5. Click a **citation chip** in the answer — it jumps to the exact spot in the source it used.
6. In the **Studio** panel, click **Study Guide** to generate one from the sources.
7. Still in **Studio**, click **Audio Overview** and **Generate**. After a minute or two you get a short podcast — two AI hosts discussing *this workshop*. Press play.

You should see

- Your uploaded PDFs listed as **Sources** on the left.
- A chat answer that explains the loop **and shows citation chips** pointing back into the handouts — not a generic answer from the open web.
- A **Study Guide** with key terms and review questions drawn from your sources.
- An **Audio Overview**: a ~5-minute, two-host audio “deep dive” summarising the workshop you just did.

If it looks wrong

- **Can’t sign in / no notebook appears**: confirm you are logged into a personal Google account (the same one from Block 5). NotebookLM is free but requires a Google sign-in.
- **Upload rejected or “limit reached”**: the free tier caps how many sources and how much you can generate per day. Upload fewer PDFs (B2 and B3 are enough), or switch to the facilitator’s screen.
- **Audio Overview is slow or queued**: generation takes a minute or two and can queue at busy times — keep exploring the chat while it finishes, or watch the facilitator’s pre-generated one.
- **Answer has no citations**: you likely asked before the sources finished loading, or asked something the sources don’t cover. Re-ask once the sources show as ready, and keep the question about the handout content.